

SCHOOLFEES MANAGER

User Guide

Fees & Billing Module

Define fee items, configure class bills, and manage adjustments

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1. Overview

The Fees & Billing module is the heart of the system. It defines what charges apply to which students, automatically generates bills, and handles adjustments like waivers, scholarships, and partial fee freezes.

Two-step setup

Step 1 — Fee Items: Define the types of charges your school applies (Tuition, Books, Boarding, PTA Levy, Exam Fee, etc.). These are reusable templates.

Step 2 — Bill Configuration: For each class and term, decide which fee items apply, how much, and to which students (boys/girls, day/boarding, new/returning).

NOTE

Set up Fee Items once. Set up Bill Configuration each new term (or copy from the previous term). Students get billed automatically based on these rules.

2. Managing Fee Items

A fee item is a single type of charge. The system ships with common Nigerian school items (Tuition, PTA Levy, Boarding Fee, etc.) — you can add or rename them to match your school.

Add a fee item

1. In the sidebar, click **Fees -> Fee Items**.
2. Click + **Add Fee Item**.
3. Enter a clear, short **Name** (e.g., "Tuition", "Hostel Fee"). Avoid all-caps.
4. Optionally add a **Description** for staff context.
5. Click **Save**.

IMPORTANT

Once a fee item is used in any bill configuration, its **name is locked** — you cannot rename it because it would change historical statements. Create a new item instead if you need a different name.

3. Configuring Bills per Class and Term

Bill configuration tells the system: "For Class X in Term Y, apply Fee Item Z with amount N "— and you can target specific student groups using rules.

Set up bills for a class

1. Click **Fees -> Bill Configuration** in the sidebar.

2. At the top, select the **Class** and confirm the **Term** (it defaults to the current term).
3. Click + **Add Bill Item**.
4. Pick a **Fee Item** from the dropdown (e.g., Tuition).
5. Enter the **Amount**.
6. Set the rules — **Gender Rule**, **Student Type Rule**, and **Boarding Rule**. Leave on *All* if the fee applies to everyone in the class.
7. Tick **Compulsory** if the fee cannot be waived for the student (most fees should be compulsory).
8. Click **Save**. The bill is added to all students who match the rules.

Understanding the rules

Gender Rule	All / Male only / Female only — useful for hostel charges that vary by sex.
Student Type	All / New students only / Returning students only — for one-off entry fees.
Boarding Rule	All / Day students only / Boarding only — for hostel fees, feeding, etc.
Compulsory	If on, the student must pay this fee (cannot be waived).

Copy bills from previous term

When a new term begins and the fees are the same as last term, you do not need to re-enter them. Click **Copy from Previous Term** at the top of the Bill Configuration page and select the source term. All items copy over; you can adjust amounts after.

4. Adjusting a Student's Bill (Waivers / Discounts)

Sometimes a specific student needs a discount or full waiver (scholarship, staff child, sibling discount, hardship). The system supports adjusting one student's bill without changing the master configuration.

1. Find the student in the **Students** page and click their name to open the profile.
2. Click the **Billing** tab on the student profile.
3. Find the bill line you want to adjust and click **Adjust**.
4. Choose the adjustment type: **Discount** (reduce amount), **Full Waiver** (set to zero), or **Freeze** (temporarily exclude from total).
5. Enter the new amount and a **Reason** (required — staff signatures need a paper trail).
6. Click **Apply Adjustment**. The student's outstanding balance updates immediately.

NOTE

All adjustments are logged with the username, timestamp, and reason. Admins can review them on the student's profile and in the Audit Log.

5. Common Billing Scenarios

A new fee item for next term	Fees -> Fee Items -> Add. Then go to Bill Configuration and add it to each relevant class.
Hostel fee for boarders only	Bill Configuration -> Add -> Boarding Rule = "Boarding Only". Day students skip it automatically.
Different tuition for new vs returning	Add Tuition twice in Bill Configuration: one with Student Type = New (¥60,000), one with Student Type = Returning (¥50,000).
Free education for staff children	Apply a Full Waiver per student via the Billing tab on their profile, with reason "Staff child - Letter ref XYZ".
Mid-term price change	Edit the Bill Configuration line. The system asks whether to apply to existing bills or only new ones — usually choose "Apply to existing" so all students see the new amount.